

Benefits Evaluation

TC: TC-1005 (TC)

MCG Health
Transitions of Care
28th Edition

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Assessment

Case Management Evaluation

Q1. Case Manager: What is the patient's current healthcare coverage? (Check all that apply.)

- Private insurance [Q2] [Q4]
- COBRA [Q2] [Q4]
- Coinsurance [Q2] [Q4]
- Disability, specify: _____ [Q2] [Q4]
- Medicaid [Q2] [Q4]
- Medicare (Part A, B, C, D), specify: _____ [Q2] [Q4]
- Medigap (Medicare supplement Part F, G, K, L, M, N), specify: _____ [Q2] [Q4]
- Medicare and Medicaid (dual eligible) [Q2] [Q4]
- Self-pay
- TRICARE [Q2] [Q4]
- Veterans Affairs (VA) benefits [Q2] [Q4]
- Workers' compensation [Q2] [Q4]
- Other, specify: _____ [Q2] [Q4]
- None
- Unknown [P1] [P2]

Q2. Case Manager: What services are covered and at what amount, if applicable? (Complete all that apply.)

- Behavioral health care services, specify: _____ [Q3]
- Durable medical equipment, specify: _____ [Q3]
- Emergency department services, specify: _____ [Q3]
- Home healthcare, specify: _____ [Q3]
- Hospitalization, specify: _____ [Q3]
- Imaging, specify: _____ [Q3]
- Inpatient rehabilitation facility (IRF) care, specify: _____ [Q3]
- Laboratory services, specify: _____ [Q3]
- Long-term acute care hospitalization (LTACH), specify: _____ [Q3]
- Long-term (custodial) care, specify: _____ [Q3]
- Medications, specify: _____ [Q3]
- Outpatient rehabilitation, specify: _____ [Q3]
- Skilled nursing facility (SNF) or subacute care, specify: _____ [Q3]
- Specialist provider services, specify: _____ [Q3]
- Other, specify: _____ [Q3]
- Unknown [P1] [P2]
- Not applicable

Q3. Case Manager: Does service require preauthorization? If yes, specify who is obtaining preauthorization.

- Yes, specify: _____
- No
- Unknown [P1] [P2]

Q4. Case Manager: What are the benefit limits? (Complete all that apply.)

- Behavioral health care services, specify: _____ [Q5]
- Emergency department services, specify: _____
- Home healthcare, specify: _____ [Q5]
- Hospitalization, specify: _____ [Q5]
- Inpatient rehabilitation facility (IRF) care, specify: _____ [Q5]
- Lifetime maximum, specify: _____ [Q5]
- Long-term acute care hospitalization (LTACH), specify: _____ [Q5]
- Long-term (custodial) care, specify: _____ [Q5]
- Medications, specify: _____ [Q5]
- Outpatient rehabilitation, specify: _____ [Q5]
- Skilled nursing facility (SNF) or subacute care, specify: _____ [Q5]
- Other, specify: _____ [Q5]
- Unknown [P1] [P2]
- Not applicable

Q5. Case Manager: Is the patient at or near their benefit limit?

- Yes, specify: _____ [P2]
- No
- Unknown [P1] [P2]

Q6. Case Manager: What are the out-of-pocket costs for the patient to get these services? (Complete all that apply.)

- Behavioral health care services, specify: _____
- Emergency department services, specify: _____
- Home healthcare, specify: _____
- Hospitalization, specify: _____
- Inpatient rehabilitation facility (IRF) care, specify: _____
- Long-term acute care hospitalization (LTACH), specify: _____
- Long-term (custodial) care, specify: _____
- Medications, specify: _____
- Outpatient rehabilitation, specify: _____
- Skilled nursing facility (SNF) or subacute care, specify: _____
- Other, specify: _____
- Unknown [P1]

Q7. Case Manager: Has the patient (or designee) been informed of out-of-pocket expenses?

- Yes [Q8]
- No [P1]
- Unknown [P1]

Q8. Case Manager: Is the patient able to meet their financial obligations?

- Yes
- No [B1] [P2]
- Unknown [P1]

Patient Interview

Q1. Patient: Do you know what your out-of-pocket costs are for your healthcare? If so, specify. (Check all that apply.)

- Copayment (co-pay), specify: _____
- Deductible, specify: _____
- Lifetime maximum, specify: _____
- Percentage of costs, specify: _____
- Other, specify: _____
- Unknown [P1]

Q2. Patient: Can you afford your out-of-pocket costs for healthcare?

- Yes
- No [Q3] [B1]
- Unknown [P1]

Q3. Patient: What costs are you not able to cover?

- Specify: _____ [P2]
- Unknown [P1]

Plan of Care

Barriers

B1. Financial barrier

Problems

P1. Healthcare benefit information needed

- **Goal:** Healthcare benefit information understood(1)(2)**N**

- **Interventions:**

- **RECONCILE:** Benefits from multiple sources, if needed
- **ASSIST:** Identifying available financial coverage for current and potential future healthcare services
- **EDUCATE:** Types of healthcare coverage (as applicable for patient's situation)(3):
 - Dental benefits/coverage - health plan payment for dental services (eg, annual examination or fillings)[A]
 - Catastrophic health plan - health plan that covers medical care for catastrophic health needs (eg, tetraplegia (quadriplegia)) but requires the patient to cover all medical costs up to a certain amount (deductible)
 - Children's Health Insurance Program (CHIP) - health insurance program for low-income children (and possibly pregnant women or families that do not qualify for Medicaid)
 - Flexible spending account (FSA) - an employer-offered savings account that an employed patient can put money into before paying taxes on that income. The employee usually can decide how much money to put into the account. Money in the account has to be spent for qualified healthcare expenses, and usually has to be spent by the end of a certain period (eg, a calendar year).
 - Health saving account (HSA) - a savings account into which an employee with a high-deductible health plan can put money before paying taxes on that income. Money in the account has to be spent for qualified healthcare expenses, and usually has to be spent by the end of a certain period (eg, a calendar year).
 - In/out of network - some health plans have networks of care providers and offer reduced out-of-pocket expenses to patients who use providers in the network. In some cases, health plans may not cover any costs if patients seek care from out-of-network providers.
 - Long-term care insurance - financial coverage for custodial care services
 - Medicare Part A - Medicare financial coverage primarily for hospital-related expenses, or services in lieu of hospitalization (eg, DME)
 - Medicare Part B - Medicare financial coverage primarily for outpatient care-related expenses
 - Medicare Part C - type of Medicare offered through a commercial health plan to provide all of a patient's Medicare Part A and B benefits
 - Medicare Part D - Medicare financial coverage of prescription medications for patients who enroll in the program
 - Medicare Part F - Medicare supplement (Medigap) financial coverage for coinsurance and deductibles under Part A and B, Part B preventive care coinsurance, Part A hospice coinsurance, SNF coinsurance, and foreign travel medical care
 - Medicare Part G - Medicare supplement (Medigap), coverage the same as Part F except does not cover Part B deductible
 - Medicare Part K - Medicare supplement (Medigap), financial coverage for coinsurance costs of Medicare Part A up to an additional 365 days once Medicare benefits have been used. It covers at 50% Part B coinsurance and co-pays, Part A hospice coinsurance and co-pays, SNF coinsurance, and Part A deductible.
 - Medicare Part L - Medicare supplement (Medigap), financial coverage as for Part K but at 75%
 - Medicare Part M - Medicare supplement (Medigap), financial coverage for coinsurance costs of Medicare Part A up to an additional 365 days once Medicare benefits have been used, Part B co-pays and coinsurance, Part A hospice co-pays and coinsurance, SNF coinsurance, and 50% of Part A deductible. It also covers foreign travel emergency expenses (up to plan limit) and Part B preventive services.
 - Medicare Part N - Medicare supplement (Medigap), financial coverage for Part A coinsurance, Part B co-pays and coinsurance (with an out-of-pocket limit), Part A hospice co-pays and coinsurance, SNF coinsurance, Part A deductible, foreign travel emergency expenses, and Part B preventive care
 - Medicaid - health insurance program offered by states and intended for people with low incomes or disabilities
 - Private/commercial insurance - financial coverage for healthcare costs by patient's participation in a private company insurance program
 - State Health Insurance Assistance Program (SHIP) - a state-provided healthcare program to provide free healthcare coverage counseling for patients with Medicare
 - TRICARE - financial coverage for healthcare services for active-duty or retired military personnel and their families
 - Veterans Affairs (VA) benefits - financial coverage for healthcare costs for patients who have appropriate military service
 - Vision benefits - health plan payment for vision-related services (eg, annual examination, corrective lenses)[B]
 - Waiver programs - cover services for the patient to allow them to stay in the community rather than a nursing facility. Coverage is determined on a case-by-case basis, with availability and allowed coverage based on state allowance.(4)

- Workers' compensation - financial coverage by employers for healthcare services related to illness or injury occurring on the job
- **EDUCATE:** Benefit terminology:
 - Annual limit - a maximum amount that a health plan will pay for the patient's healthcare in a year. It is often imposed for types of healthcare services (eg, medications or hospitalizations). Once the annual limit is met, the patient will be responsible for all costs of that care.
 - Benefit year - what the patient's health plan will pay for in a year. The benefit year is usually the calendar year.
 - Coinsurance - refers to the patient's percentile share of the costs for their healthcare service. For example, if the coinsurance is 20% for a \$100 provider appointment, the patient is responsible for \$20.
 - Copayment - a set payment amount that the patient is responsible for when getting a healthcare service. This payment is made by the patient every time they use the service. For example, the patient may pay \$20 for every appointment.
 - Cost sharing - the patient's share of the healthcare costs; it generally refers to any type of out-of-pocket expense (eg, coinsurance or copayment). Patients may be responsible for any combination of the costs of their care.
 - Deductible - the amount of money the patient must pay for healthcare services before the insurance company will start to pay. For example, if the patient's deductible is \$1000, then the patient is responsible for the first \$1000 of healthcare costs. Once the \$1000 is paid, then the health plan starts to pay for care. Deductibles may not apply to all healthcare services; for example, the patient may have a deductible for hospital care but not for provider appointments.
 - Excluded services - healthcare services that the patient's health plan does not pay for
 - Lifetime limit - a limit on the total amount of healthcare costs a health plan will pay for a patient's healthcare. For example, there may be a total lifetime limit of \$500,000 over the course of a patient's life.
 - More information can be found at www.healthcare.gov.
- **EDUCATE:** Financial planning options (eg, payment programs)
- **EDUCATE:** How to save on out-of-pocket costs:
 - Use in-network providers.
 - Ask provider if any previsit testing can be done (to save on need for return visit).
 - Health Marketplace Silver members can save based on income.
- **COORDINATE:** Submitting status report information on patient's condition to appropriate payer, if needed
- **COORDINATE:** Contact with providers if patient cannot afford aspect of care
- **COORDINATE:** Social worker referral, as needed
- **COORDINATE:** Community services referral, as needed
- **COORDINATE:** Financial counseling or assistance
- **COORDINATE:** Follow-up to evaluate understanding of healthcare benefits (eg, coverage or access), referral status, and need for further assistance(5)(6)

P2. Potential complication: financial issues present

- **Goal:** Financial resources identified and sufficient to continue care(2)(7) 
- **Interventions:**
 - **ASSIST:** Identifying healthcare benefits coverage from payers
 - **ASSIST:** Identifying availability of and eligibility for alternative financial resources
 - **ASSIST:** Communicating information on patient's healthcare benefits coverage with treatment team
 - **ASSIST:** Appointment scheduling and completing paperwork to support applications for financial support
 - **EDUCATE:** Healthcare benefits and out-of-pocket expenses
 - **EDUCATE:** Resources for financial assistance:
 - Administration for Children & Families: www.acf.hhs.gov
 - Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS): www.medicare.gov/drug-coverage-part-d
 - Medicine Assistance Tool: <https://medicineassistancetool.org>
 - NeedyMeds. Find help with the cost of medicine: www.needymeds.org
 - Individual pharmaceutical company websites
 - **COORDINATE:** Financial assistance referral; examples include:
 - Area Agency on Aging
 - Disease advocacy
 - Financial counseling or assistance
 - Food banks or other sources for nutritional support and financial assistance
 - Government agencies
 - Legal aid
 - Long-term disability application
 - Medicaid application
 - Medicare application
 - Pharmacy assistance programs
 - Short-term disability application
 - Supplemental Security Income (SSI) or disability benefits application

- Veterans Affairs (VA) benefits application
 - **COORDINATE:** Social worker referral, as needed(8)
 - **COORDINATE:** Follow-up for evaluation of referral status and need for further assistance(6)(9)
- **Goal:** Financial issues addressed(7)
 - **Interventions:**
 - **RECONCILE:** Benefits from multiple sources, if needed
 - **ASSIST:** Obtaining preauthorization from health plan provider, if appropriate
 - **EDUCATE:** Source and type of financial support, how to access, and if follow-up needed
 - **COORDINATE:** Follow-up for evaluation of use of support programs or ongoing need for further assistance(6)(9)

Evidence Summary

Quality standards: Standards indicate that programs should facilitate and follow up with referrals. Programs should identify patient barriers and adherence concerns.(10)

Quality standards: Standards indicate that programs should have a process for identifying barriers to patients meeting goals or adhering to the case management plan and for following up with patients on the status of referrals.(10)

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Footnotes

[A] The patient's medical health plan may have some benefits for dental care (eg, if surgical dental care is needed due to the need for use of an operating room or level of anesthesia). Patients may also have a separate dental health plan. [A in Context Link 1]

[B] The patient's medical health plan may have some benefits for vision care. Patients may also have a separate vision health plan. [B in Context Link 1]

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